



ERIC THAYER/AP

A protester confronts a line of National Guard troops near the metropolitan detention center in downtown Los Angeles on Sunday.

A diminished DOGE reels from Musk’s departure

This article is by Faiz Siddiqui, Hannah Natanson, Cat Zakrzewski, Alex Horton and Elizabeth Dwoskin

Cabinet officials and senior staffers across the Trump administration are reclaiming power from Elon Musk’s U.S. DOGE Service, a trend that began long before the billionaire’s relationship with President Donald Trump exploded in public acrimony days after Musk formally left his White House post.

As Musk departed, some of his

The future of the group dedicated to cutting costs remains unclear

top lieutenants were streaming out of government. Among those heading for the exits even before Musk and Trump began feuding, according to a White House official who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive

information: longtime aide Steve Davis, who was overseeing cost-cutting efforts; lawyer James Burnham, DOGE’s general counsel; and DOGE adviser Katie Miller, who is married to White House Deputy Chief of Staff Stephen Miller. Katie Miller is now working for Musk.

Meanwhile, Cabinet officials — some of whom had clashed with Musk — are moving to rehire workers who had been pushed out by DOGE. And while the group retains some clout, with

DOGE staffers moving into permanent jobs in some agencies, unaffiliated political appointees in other departments have been forcing the cost-cutting group to back off.

Despite the exodus, White House officials said the administration remains dedicated to rooting out waste and abuse. The administration has asked Congress to cancel more than \$9 billion in spending for global health aid and for public broadcasting in

SEE DOGE ON A9

Republican tax bill reveals striking shift in the party’s focus

BY JEFF STEIN

The sweeping tax legislation Republicans in Congress are trying to send to President Donald Trump to sign into law underscores a striking evolution in the party’s economic agenda: away from tax policy that prioritizes economic growth and toward

populist giveaways inspired by Trump’s campaign promises.

House Republicans last month approved a \$2.4 trillion proposal that included attention-grabbing provisions such as exempting tips and overtime pay from income taxes and a new deduction for seniors. The bill’s cornerstone, making up the vast majority

of its price tag, is the permanent extension of the individual cuts from the 2017 GOP tax law, which lowered rates across income brackets.

But the size of these policies comes at a cost. Critics, including many conservative experts who supported the first Trump tax legislation, say the bill will sacrifice

long-term economic growth to deliver on these short-term political promises. Unlike the 2017 law, which centered on a large corporate tax cut that conservatives believe juiced investment, this year’s measure would primarily shower smaller amounts of cash on tens of millions of households

SEE BILL ON A8

Tensions rise as troops confront L.A. protesters

OFFICERS USE TEAR GAS ON DEMONSTRATORS

Trump deployed Guard, bypassing California officials

BY MOLLY HENNESSY-FISKE, REIS THEBAULT AND MARK BERMAN

LOS ANGELES — Hundreds of National Guard troops dispatched by President Donald Trump arrived here Sunday as protesters continued demonstrating against his administration’s immigration crackdown.

While calm reigned for much of the day, tensions flared anew in the afternoon as authorities lobbed tear gas at a growing crowd of protesters gathered by the Edward R. Roybal Federal Building, which houses an immigration detention center near the city’s downtown core. The Los Angeles police said people in the crowd were “throwing concrete, bottles and other objects” and that officers had begun making arrests and telling people to disperse.

The National Guard’s arrival

marks a new, potentially volatile phase in the Trump administration’s push to ramp up deportations and its contentious relationship with state and local authorities.

Trump over the weekend ordered 2,000 National Guard personnel to deploy following protests against immigration raids in the Los Angeles area that at times turned violent. And he acted over the objections of state and local officials in California — a state that is a frequent target of Trump’s ire — who denounced the move as unnecessary and incendiary.

Gov. Gavin Newsom (D) on Sunday asked the Trump administration to rescind the decision to call up the California National Guard, with his office writing that the move was stepping on the state’s sovereignty and depriving it of control of its own

SEE PROTESTS ON A4

Legal experts question Trump’s use of Guard

Deployment without governor’s backing a rare break from precedent

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL AND ALEX HORTON

President Donald Trump’s order to deploy 2,000 California National Guard troops to Los Angeles appears unprecedented, relying on an unorthodox use of a law aimed at quelling serious domestic unrest or an attack on the United States by a foreign power, some legal experts said Sunday.

It marks the first time in about 60 years that an American president has taken such action without a governor’s consent. Furthermore, his executive order autho-

rizes the Pentagon to dispatch military personnel domestically to enable federal functions and protect government property — a chilling sign, the experts said, that Trump is prepared to send troops into other cities in response to protests.

“That is completely unprecedented under any legal authority,” said Elizabeth Goitein, senior director of the Liberty and National Security Program at the Brennan Center for Justice. “The use of the military to quell civil unrest is supposed to be an absolute last resort.”

Trump invoked a section of U.S. code that allows the president to bypass a governor’s authority over the National Guard and call those

SEE TRUMP ON A5

‘Just grabbing people’: Day laborers describe L.A. raids. A7

Major progress unlikely at U.S.-China trade talks

Fundamental divisions make a comprehensive settlement difficult

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

The U.S.-China trade negotiations scheduled to begin in London on Monday are likely to produce at best a limited accord that might slow but not stop the erosion in commercial links between the nations while leaving Beijing’s state capitalist system unchanged.

President Donald Trump said Friday that Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick and U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer will represent the United States at the meeting, which aims to bridge deep disputes over trade and technology. Vice Premier He Lifeng is expected to lead the Chinese team.

But China’s determination to reduce its dependence on other countries, particularly the United States, and Trump’s erratic approach to trade diplomacy will make it difficult for the world’s largest economies to reach a comprehensive settlement, including on fundamental questions about the nature of China’s economy, analysts said.

“We are seeing what U.S.-China trade competition looks like when it’s unmoored from any principles. The U.S. is not trying to defend the rules-based order. It’s not trying to defend market economies from Chinese misbehavior. It’s just simply trying to cut a deal that’s in the short-term self-interest of the American leader,” said Scott Kennedy, a senior adviser at the Center for Strategic and International Studies in Washington.

The White House and Treasury Department did not respond to requests for comment.

But Bessent, who will lead the

SEE TRADE ON A8

For pro golf, YouTubers are links to the future

LIV and PGA embrace outlandish content creators’ growing popularity to attract new and younger fans



TASOS KATOPODIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Rick Shiels, who has nearly 3 million YouTube followers, is interviewed at LIV Golf Virginia last week.

BY RICK MAESE

Back before all of this — before all the followers, the videos, the acclaim — Rick Shiels was just an anonymous golf pro in Manchester, England, trying to drum up some business. Clean-shaven and fresh-faced, he turned to YouTube and posted videos with swing tips in hopes of attracting new clients.

“If you asked me what I did for a living, I’d tell you, I’m a golf coach,” Shiels explained, “because I’ll be honest, I was quite embarrassed to say I’m a YouTuber. At the time it was quite a stigma; it wasn’t a positive statement.”

But now, 13 years and 2,500 videos later, for some golf fans, Shiels is more popular, more recognizable and more relevant than many of the world’s best players. He has nearly 3 million YouTube followers. He has a staff of 15. He has sponsors and contracts, including a multiyear

SEE LIV ON A16

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All the way back Carlos Alcaraz rallies past Jannik Sinner to win the French Open men’s singles title for the second straight year. D1

A community disrupted On Martha’s Vineyard, immigration arrests ignite fear among the undocumented workers who are the backbone of the workforce. A6

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Virginia Democrats are debating whether Elon Musk’s value as a political target will wane as he steps back from government. B1

STYLE

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